

Understood. My apologies for that. Let's focus strictly on a text-based, objective, and unbiased informational layout designed to help you and other Lehigh County voters navigate the November ballot clearly and transparently.

## Lehigh County Non-Partisan Election Guide (November 2026)

This reference sheet outlines the core elements on your ballot as a registered non-affiliated voter in Allentown, Lehigh County.

### 1. Your Voter Rights as a Non-Affiliated Party Member

- **Full Ballot Access:** In Pennsylvania, general elections are open to all registered voters. Your non-affiliated status has zero impact on your ballot; you receive the exact same official ballot as registered Democrats or Republicans.
- **Write-ins and Independents:** You can vote for any candidate from any registered party, any recognized minor party, or qualified independent and write-in candidates.

### 2. Lehigh County Ballot Referendums (Home Rule Charter Questions)

Every voter in Lehigh County will see three countywide questions on their ballot:

- **Question 1 (Election Commission Expansion):**
  - *What it does:* Proposes expanding the Lehigh County Election and Registration Commission from 3 members to 5 members (structured as 2 Democrats, 2 Republicans, and 1 member from the third-largest political affiliation in the county, such as an independent or unaffiliated voter) and removes the County Executive.
- **Question 2 (Legal Newspaper Notices):**
  - *What it does:* Amends the charter to allow the county to publish mandatory public notices in at least 1 newspaper of general circulation instead of the current requirement of 2 separate newspapers.
- **Question 3 (Retirement Board Representation):**
  - *What it does:* Removes the mandate requiring the Chair of the Board of Commissioners to personally sit on the Lehigh County Retirement Board, allowing the board to designate any commissioner to serve.

### 3. Major Candidate Contests on Your Ballot

Depending on your exact street address in Allentown, your ballot includes:

- **U.S. House of Representatives (PA-07):** A nationally watched toss-up race covering Lehigh, Northampton, and parts of Carbon and Monroe counties. The general election features:
  - **Ryan Mackenzie** (Republican — Incumbent)
  - **Bob Brooks** (Democrat — Challenger)
  - **Andrew Tupone** (Green)
- **Pennsylvania Governor:** The statewide executive election featuring:
  - **Josh Shapiro** (Democrat — Incumbent)
  - **Stacy Garrity** (Republican — Challenger)
  - **Ken Krawchuk** (Libertarian)
- **PA General Assembly:** Local State Senate (Districts 14, 16, or 18) and State House

(Districts 22, 131, 132, 134, 183, or 187) representatives depending on your specific Allentown neighborhood precinct.

#### **4. Key Deadlines & Logistics**

- **Voter Registration Deadline:** October 19, 2026.
- **Mail-In / Absentee Ballot Application Deadline:** October 27, 2026 (by 5:00 PM).
- **Mail-In Ballot Return Deadline:** Must be received by the Lehigh County Board of Elections by 8:00 PM on **Election Day, November 3, 2026** (postmarks do not count).
- **Polling Hours:** Open from 7:00 AM to 8:00 PM on November 3.